

Dan Welch

Senior Software Engineer | Design Systems & Front-End Architecture

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 Remote | Open to relocation

SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 17+ years of experience building scalable front-end platforms, design systems, and developer experiences. Primary architect of multiple enterprise design systems across Bankrate and Launch That, including React/Next.js component platforms, design token pipelines, and reusable UI architectures adopted across product teams. Experienced in partnering with engineering, product, and design organizations to improve delivery velocity, consistency, accessibility, and maintainability. Strong background in TypeScript, React, Tailwind CSS, Storybook, and modern AI-assisted engineering workflows.

ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- Architected and launched enterprise design systems supporting multiple product teams.
- Partnered with design leadership to define system direction and scalable UI patterns.
- Established automated testing and release workflows, improving developer confidence and adoption.
- Served as Engineering Manager, partnering with stakeholders and PMs to align roadmap priorities with company goals.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | Design Systems Architect, Red Ventures / Bankrate

09/2021 – 06/2026

Remote

- **Architected and led the implementation of The Ledger**, Bankrate's React/Next.js design system, creating a scalable component platform adopted across product teams. Built 65+ reusable components with TypeScript and Tailwind, supporting white-label theming through a token-based architecture.
- **Built the operational foundation for Ledger**, including automated testing, accessibility validation, CI workflows, token compilation, and versioned releases to support reliable adoption across engineering teams.
- **Architected and led the implementation of The Treasury**, Bankrate's first formal design system. Launched Jan 2025 and adopted across a dozen-plus projects with zero production incidents, replacing a legacy CSS framework. Later succeeded by The Ledger following a leadership-directed shift to React/Next.js-native delivery.
- **Led a Storyblok component audit** that eliminated 289 components (~30%), improving maintainability and simplifying content workflows for product teams. Built a custom internal dashboard to track and report progress for stakeholders.
- **Authored Playwright E2E suites** integrated into GitHub Actions. Cut CI execution time by ~76% and caught pre-release regressions before they entered production.
- **Served on Bankrate's A11y and Performance task forces**, resolving WCAG compliance issues and conducting performance audits across product teams, and acting as an internal consultant on Core Web Vitals best practices and front-end performance optimization.
- **Integrated AI tools** (Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Codex) into daily workflow for component generation, documentation, and code review. Shared practices in bi-weekly team meetings and co-lead a hackathon focused on AI-assisted development.
- **Drove design system education and adoption company-wide**, facilitating lunch-and-learns for cross-functional groups of engineers, designers, and product managers. One-on-one mentoring with developers on component architecture, advanced CSS, Tailwind optimization, and design system standards.

Engineering Manager Interim, Red Ventures / Bankrate	03/2025 – 09/2025
• Managed a team of 7 (4 FTEs + 3 contractors) over 6 months, driving a ~10% increase in sprint velocity through process improvements and conducted mid-cycle performance reviews. • Co-led an internal team hackathon using AI to accelerate the migration of legacy JavaScript calculators to React and the new design system; the results directly shaped the team's future migration approach.	Remote
Senior Front-End Developer, Launch That	09/2016 – 09/2021
• Architected the Ares Framework, a custom component library and WordPress parent theme powering all Launch That properties, establishing the shared design system foundation that now defines my career. Leveraged it to ship 6 multi-page WordPress sites in a single month. • Trained directly with Brad Frost (creator of the Atomic Design methodology, which focuses on modular interface design) in a hands-on two-day design system workshop, laying the groundwork for the approaches used in Ares and later at Bankrate. • Built ReportaRoo and DisavOwl, two in-house Vue.js tools automating marketing reporting and streamlining the SEO link-disavow process, a task previously done manually by analysts.	Orlando, FL
Lead Front-End / Senior Web Developer, Studio Birdsall	08/2014 – 09/2016
• Led front-end development across 10+ client projects, including Magento and Shopify e-commerce builds and custom WordPress sites, delivering production-ready websites on schedule.	Winter Park, FL
Senior Web Developer, Full Sail University	10/2008 – 08/2014
• Led front-end development for Full Sail University, including the main marketing sites, blog, hundreds of landing pages & email campaigns, and the interfaces for the university's first online store and online school. Advanced from Web Developer to Senior within three years.	Winter Park, FL

EDUCATION

B.S. Digital Arts & Design, Full Sail University Valedictorian	09/2006 – 08/2008
	Winter Park, FL
Digital Media, University of Maine	09/2005 – 05/2006
	Orono, ME

SKILLS

Languages TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, PHP	Frameworks & Libraries React, Next.js, Vue.js, Astro, Node.js, Tailwind CSS v4, Laravel
Design Systems Component Architecture, Storybook, Design Tokens (DTCG), ShadCN Registry, Multi-Brand Theming / White-Labeling	Practices Accessibility (WCAG / A11y), Core Web Vitals, Responsive Design, Figma Collaboration, Design-to-Code Handoff, UI/UX Consulting
CMS & Platforms Storyblok (Headless CMS), WordPress (Blade or Twig templating, ACF, Gutenberg), Shopify	Testing & CI/CD Playwright (E2E), Vitest, Jest, axe-core, Biome, GitHub Actions, Semantic Release (semver / conventional commits)
AI & Modern Workflow Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex, MCP tooling; daily use across code generation, refactoring, documentation, and design-system development; custom rules & prompt authoring	